



Louise Brown, aged two, plays at her home in Bristol, UK



In 1977, James Elliot, Jessica Mink, and Edward Dunham discover that the planet Uranus has rings just like Saturn.

1978

First test tube baby

Louise Brown from England became the first baby conceived using IVF (in vitro fertilization). During IVF, an egg cell is removed from a woman's ovaries and fertilized with a male sperm cell in a laboratory. The fertilized egg, known as an embryo, is then returned to the woman's womb to grow and develop. IVF has since helped millions of couples have children.

1979

Reaching Saturn

Launched in 1973, NASA's spacecraft Pioneer 11 became the first space probe to fly past Saturn. Traveling just 13,048 miles (21,000 km) above the planet's atmosphere, the probe discovered two new moons and a new ring around the planet.

Artist's impression of Pioneer 11 passing by Saturn



1980



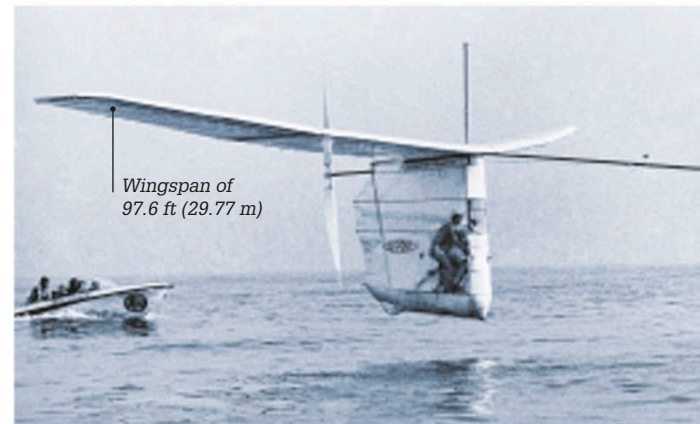
1978

Early fossil footprints

British archaeologist Mary Leakey reported the discovery of fossilized footprints made by two-legged creatures more than 3.6 million years ago. Found in Laetoli, Tanzania, a trail of some 70 footprints were made in volcanic ash that hardened into rock. They showed how our predecessors walked upright far earlier than previously thought.



Part of the 78.7-ft- (24-m-) long trail of footprints found at Laetoli, Tanzania



Gossamer Albatross crosses the English Channel

Wingspan of 97.6 ft (29.77 m)

1979

Channel crossing

The Gossamer Albatross aircraft made the first human-powered flight across the English Channel. It was piloted on its 22.1 mile (35.7 km) trip by American cyclist and pilot Bryan Allen, who pedaled to turn a single, large propeller. The plane was made of polystyrene, carbon fiber tubes, and other ultra-light materials, and weighed just 70.5 lb (32 kg).

